

Standard Chartered

1Q26 first take: Strong income performance

Maintain Rating: NEUTRAL | PO: 209.80 HKD | Price: 187.20 HKD

Overall: Strong 1Q26, wealth momentum continues

Overall, Standard Chartered printed a strong set of 1Q26 numbers, with PBT 14% (or \$306m) ahead of consensus. This was largely driven by strong income, while cost and impairment were in line. CET1 was 0.4% miss to consensus, reflecting higher RWAs (2% above consensus) driven by asset growth and Market Risk RWAs. No change to guidance; medium term guidance will be provided in May. We remain Neutral on the stock, as we balance strong fundamentals with uncertainty in the geopolitical outlook.

Strong income driven by Wealth and Banking

Income was the main driver of the PBT beat. The income beat of 6% (or \$316m) was driven by Global Banking (\$69m, 12% beat), Wealth Solutions (\$122m, 13% beat), and Treasury and Other (\$126m including DVA \$65m). Wealth Solutions saw particularly strong growth (up 32% year on year), with record net new money of \$18bn delivered in the quarter.

Impairment: \$190m precautionary overlay

No material credit deterioration was observed in the quarter. Management took \$190m of overlays and post-model adjustments (PMAs) in relation to the Middle East conflict. Overlays were taken for petrochemical sector and potential sovereign downgrades.

Balance sheet: Good growth particularly from CIB

Underlying loans and deposits were both up c.3% in the quarter, with most of the increase in the quarter driven by CIB, although deposit from WRB also benefitted from Affluent Net New Money flows. RWAs was up 3% in the quarter, reflecting asset growth and mix, as well as higher Market Risk RWA.

30 April 2026

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Stock Data

Price	187.20 HKD
Price Objective	209.80 HKD
Date Established	2-Feb-2026
Investment Opinion	B-2-7
52-Week Range	108.20 HKD-206.00 HKD
Mkt Val / Shares Out (mn)	53,252 USD / 2,229.3
Market Value (mn)	417,329 HKD
Average Daily Value (mn)	33.13 USD
Free Float	100.0%
BofA Ticker / Exchange	XCHBF / HKG
Bloomberg / Reuters	2888 HK / 2888.HK
ROE (2026E)	10.4%

CET1: Core Equity Tier 1

NII: Net Interest Income

PBT: Profit Before Tax

RWA: Risk Weighted Asset

FFG: Fit For Growth

CTA: Cost To Achieve

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1Q26 results vs consensus

Exhibit 1: 1Q26 results vs consensus

PBT beat of 14% largely driven by higher income

	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26					
	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Cons	BofA	Cons	1Q25	4Q25
Profit & loss													
Net interest income	2,696	2,769	2,981	2,797	2,702	2,737	2,948	2,869	2,781	2,825	3%	3%	-3%
Non interest income	1,965	2,181	1,821	2,582	2,825	2,373	1,978	3,033	2,805	2,845	8%	17%	53%
Operating income	4,661	4,950	4,802	5,379	5,527	5,110	4,926	5,902	5,586	5,670	6%	10%	20%
Operating expenses	(3,059)	(2,971)	(3,475)	(3,046)	(3,201)	(3,144)	(3,913)	(3,140)	(3,142)	(3,190)	0%	3%	-20%
Credit impairment	(75)	(178)	(129)	(217)	(119)	(188)	(148)	(296)	(287)	(351)	3%	36%	100%
Other impairment	(87)	(88)	(353)	(15)	(4)	(22)	(24)	(2)	(20)	(16)	-90%	-87%	-92%
Associates & JVs	130	9	(44)	2	77	10	(27)	(14)	7	0	-300%	-800%	-48%
Underlying profit before tax	1,570	1,722	801	2,103	2,280	1,766	814	2,450	2,144	2,113	14%	17%	201%
Restructuring charges										0	-	-	-
DVA										0	-	-	-
Other										0	-	-	-
Statutory profit before tax	1,570	1,722	801	2,103	2,280	1,766	814	2,450	2,144	2,113	14%	17%	201%
Key metrics													
ROTE	12.9%	10.8%	7.6%	16.2%	18.9%	12.4%	8.7%	17.40%	13.8%	13.5%	3.60%	1.23%	8.68%
CET1 ratio	14.6%	14.2%	14.2%	13.8%	14.3%	14.2%	14.1%	13.4%	13.8%	13.9%	-0.4%	-0.45%	-0.72%
RWA (\$bn)	241,926	248,924	247,065	253,596	259,684	258,378	258,031	266,200	262,100	263,650	2%	5%	3%
Net customer loans	275,896	287,257	281,032	281,788	286,731	285,127	286,788	293,600	290,100	286,788	1%	4%	2%
Loan loss rate	0.11%	0.25%	0.18%	0.31%	0.17%	0.26%	0.21%	0.32%		0.49%			
TNAVPS	14.44	15.09	15.41	15.62	16.80	16.84	17.30	17.20	17.43	17.36	-1%	10%	-1%
Dividend	9.00		28.00		12.30		48.70			0.00			
Buybacks	1,500		1,500		1,300		1,500			0			

Source: Company consensus, BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Price objective basis & risk

Standard Chartered (XCHBF)

Our primary valuation methodology is a Gordon Growth Model based on our 2027e forecast, to which we add the present value of expected dividends. With a 11% cost of equity assumption, this suggests a price to book multiple of 1.5x, reducing to 1.3x when discounted to a year from now at our cost of equity. Applying this to 2026E tangible book value of 1,854c gives a value of 2,456c pre capital return. To this we add the dividends we forecast through to 2027E (also discounted), and adjust for excess capital to the bottom end of management guidance. Using this valuation approach, we arrive at a price objective of HKD209.80.

The upside risks to our PO are: 1. US rates stay higher for longer, terminal rate higher than expected, 2. further stimulus from the Chinese government, 3. Emerging Asia/ Hong Kong loan growth recovers faster than expected.

The downside risks to our PO are: 1. Loan growth remains subdued for longer, 2. Wealth Management flows slow as competition intensifies in the market, 3. Global trade flows reduce more than expected with higher tariffs.

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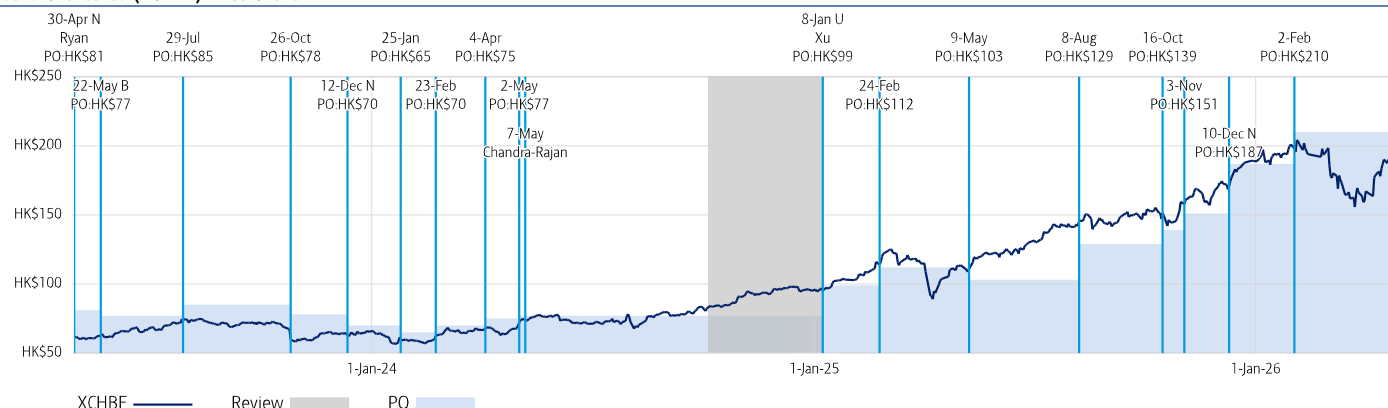
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Standard Chartered (XCHBF) Price Chart



B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

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Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	117	53.42%	Buy	98	83.76%
Hold	59	26.94%	Hold	47	79.66%
Sell	43	19.63%	Sell	35	81.40%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 31 Mar 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1993	55.76%	Buy	1186	59.51%
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Sell	760	21.26%	Sell	400	52.63%

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Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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